



Mapping continents

In 1866, Dr. David Livingstone set off on a journey to find the source of the Nile. His maps, such as the one above of central Africa, changed mapping of Africa.

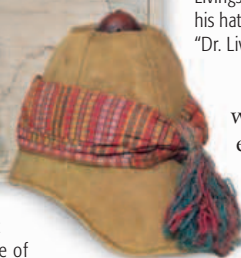
John Hanning Speke, and Verney Cameron, endured great hardships to continue their explorations. The Scottish missionary David Livingstone attempted to open up trade routes favorable to Britain. He navigated lakes and rivers, including the Zambezi River and Victoria Falls, crossing Africa from east to west. Livingstone and Henry Morton Stanley (the man who was sent to find Livingstone when he went missing in 1866–71) were important in mapping this enormous continent. The last gaps in Africa's map were not filled in until the 1920s.

The Americas

The first European to make the long trek across North America

Stanley's pith helmet

Henry Morton Stanley was sent to Africa to find Livingstone. On finding him, in 1871, he doffed his hat, and uttered the now famous words, "Dr. Livingstone, I presume."



was the Scottish-Canadian explorer Alexander Mackenzie in 1793, as he searched for the Northwest Passage—a water route to the Pacific Ocean.

In 1804, with settlements becoming overcrowded and people migrating west, US president Thomas Jefferson sent Meriwether Lewis and William Clark to explore Louisiana and the mountains and plains beyond it. They crossed the US from east to west by canoe, horse, and foot, reaching the Pacific Ocean in 1805.

A test of endurance

The North (Arctic) and South (Antarctic) poles were so inhospitable they offered little chance for exploitation, but there was prestige in being the first nation to conquer them. In 1893, Norwegian Fridtjof Nansen had failed to reach the North Pole. Competition to be the first to reach the pole intensified. A pair of Americans, Frederick Cook in 1908 and Robert Peary in 1909, both made claims to have reached the North Pole—claims that remain in dispute to this day.

While navigators of many nations had charted the coastline of Antarctica in the extreme south, it took an American expedition led by Lieutenant Charles

Wilkes (1840) to confirm that it was a continent. In 1911, two expeditions landed separately on the Ross Ice Shelf, about 900 miles (1,450 km) from the South Pole. Both the Norwegian Roald Amundsen and the Englishman Robert Falcon Scott sought to demonstrate their technological prowess and endurance. With husky-drawn sleds, Amundsen reached the pole on December 14, 1911. Halfway there, Scott sent his ponies back and dragged the sleds by hand. He reached the South Pole a month after Roald Amundsen, but died of starvation on the return journey.

Through such feats of human endeavor, geographers were able to draw the first accurate outline of the world. By the turn of the 20th century, all seven continents—Europe, Asia, Africa, North and South America, Australia, and Antarctica—were on the map.

“So we arrived, and planted our flag at the geographical South Pole. Thanks be to God!”

ROALD AMUNDSEN, NORWEGIAN EXPLORER, 1912

In the 21st century, little uncharted territory remains on Earth. However, human endurance and scientific curiosity have kept polar and space exploration alive.

POLAR EXPLORATION

The **first crossing of Antarctica** was accomplished by the British **Vivian Fuchs** and the New Zealander **Edmund Hillary** in 1957–58. American **Ralph Plaisted** became the first to reach the **North Pole using surface transport** in 1968.

SPACE HIGHLIGHTS

In April 1961, the Russian cosmonaut **Yuri Gagarin** became the first person in space. In July 1969, the US made history when Apollo 11 successfully landed on the Moon **458–61** >>.



1969 MOON LANDING

Polar dispute

This 1909 French cartoon depicts Peary and Cook, who both claimed to be the first to reach the North Pole. The fray that followed discredited both men.



Cook in New South Wales

On August 22, 1770, Captain James Cook (center, raising hat) declared the southeastern coast of Australia British and named it New South Wales. Eighteen years later, to ease prison overcrowding, the British government sent the first fleet of around 750 convicts to settle at Sydney Cove.

